Essential Privacy Tips to Protect Your Personal Information

Use Aliases for Online Accounts

- Create separate identities (sockpuppets) for different purposes (e.g., professional, social, and anonymous browsing).
- Never link aliases to your real identity—use unique profile pictures, usernames, and emails for each. For government or other official work then follow their guidelines.
- Use separate browsers or browser profiles to avoid cross-tracking of identities.
- Utilize password managers to handle multiple unique credentials securely.

Email and Messaging

- Use privacy-focused email providers like ProtonMail or Tutanota instead of Gmail or Outlook.
- Enable PGP encryption for sensitive emails and avoid using personal details in your email addresses.
- Use encrypted messaging apps like Signal, Threema, or Wire instead of mainstream options like WhatsApp or Telegram.
- Avoid linking personal phone numbers to your private messaging apps.

Utilize Virtual Mailing Addresses

- Use virtual addresses (e.g., UPS, Anytime Mailbox, Earth Class Mail, iPostal1) instead of your home address for deliveries and registrations.
- When required to provide a physical address online, use a PO Box or virtual mailbox.
- Consider a registered agent service if you own a business to keep your personal address off public filings.
- Create a DBA/sole-proprietorship business to use for privacy purposes only. Several states don't have any tax requirements or fees, making it an easy way to stay under the radar.

Use Personal Data Removal Services

- Regularly search your name on people-search websites and request removal from databases like Whitepages, Spokeo, and BeenVerified.
- Use services like DeleteMe to automate the removal of your personal data from data brokers.
- Set up Google Alerts for your name to monitor unwanted exposure of your information.
- Be cautious when providing real details on public forums or directories.

Social Media Privacy

- Lock down privacy settings on all social media platforms—limit profile visibility and remove unnecessary details.
- Avoid posting real-time location or check-in updates and personal photos that can be traced back to you.
- Use a professional alias or minimal personal details on LinkedIn to avoid recruiters and scammers scraping your data.
- Disable "resume visibility" on LinkedIn to prevent third-party job boards from collecting your data. Strip your real contact info from the resume.

Use Burner Emails and Phone Numbers for Signups

- Create burner emails using services like SimpleLogin or ProtonMail for different accounts to avoid spam and tracking.
- Use VoIP or prepaid SIM cards (e.g., Google Voice, MySudo, Hushed) instead of your real number for online verifications.
- Never link your main phone number to high-risk services like social media or online marketplaces.
- Regularly rotate your burner emails and numbers to maintain anonymity.